

Student Dissatisfaction Over Exam Season Scheduling

Arma Rahman, Elizabeth Brooks, and Surya Doeбри

The end of the year has arrived. Edison is in the final stretch of the 2026 school year with final exams, regents, SAT and PSAT for juniors and sophomores and AP Exams being one of the last things left for this school year.



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Thomas A. Edison CTE High School

This year introduced new changes to the Edison school schedule for the exams, with a new shortened schedule for exam season. However, even with this new schedule, there have been issues with introducing it earlier than usual causing a lot of distress among students and teachers.

In March, students had a shortened schedule for midterms with students who had their exam that day come in at 8 in the morning. Students would take their exams for three hours and the official school day would commence at 11:15am.

For the first three days of this schedule, each class from 1st to 8th period was 15 minutes long, with the exception of two alternating periods a day being 40 minutes long. The only class that was full length would be 9th period, these periods were lengthened on Wednesdays with the class periods being 22 minutes long.

In April, the SAT and PSATs arrived. This was after a spread of confusion between both the students and the teachers about when the tests were supposed to be

This bell schedule had the same late start at 11:18 however this schedule was adjusted to have different length times. For the SATs, the first 3 classes of the day were 7 minutes long, while for the PSATs the first 2 classes were 10 minutes long. Every other class after that with the exclusion of 9th period being regular time, was 20 and 25 minutes long respectively.

Students at Edison were asked what the school was lacking for the preparation of the midterms and the PSATS/SATS. Multiple students mentioned how the school lacked proper scheduling and how it affected their regular school schedule especially for AP students.

DAY 01: FRIDAY / MARCH 13 (Student Entry / Breakfast: 07:15 AM)

- **Pd00:** 08:00 AM – 11:15 AM (3h 15m | Testing Period)
- **Pd01:** 11:18 AM – 11:58 AM (40m)
- **Pd02:** 12:01 PM – 12:41 PM (40m)
- **Pd03:** 12:44 PM – 12:59 PM (15m)
- **Pd04:** 01:02 PM – 01:17 PM (15m)
- **Pd05:** 01:20 PM – 01:35 PM (15m)
- **Pd06:** 01:38 PM – 01:53 PM (15m)
- **Pd07:** 01:56 PM – 02:11 PM (15m)
- **Pd08:** 02:14 PM – 02:29 PM (15m)
- **Pd09:** 02:32 PM – 03:18 PM (46m)

DAY 02: MONDAY / MARCH 16 (Student Entry / Breakfast: 07:15 AM)



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Moses Ojeda, Principal

DAY 02: MONDAY / MARCH 16 (Student Entry / Breakfast: 07:15 AM)

- **Pd00:** 08:00 AM – 11:15 AM (3h 15m | Testing Period)
- **Pd01:** 11:18 AM – 11:33 AM (15m)
- **Pd02:** 11:36 PM – 11:51 PM (15m)
- **Pd03:** 11:54 PM – 12:34 PM (40m)
- **Pd04:** 12:37 PM – 01:17 PM (40m)
- **Pd05:** 01:20 PM – 01:35 PM (15m)
- **Pd06:** 01:38 PM – 01:53 PM (15m)
- **Pd07:** 01:56 PM – 02:11 PM (15m)
- **Pd08:** 02:14 PM – 02:29 PM (15m)
- **Pd09:** 02:32 PM – 03:18 PM (46m)

DAY 03: TUESDAY / MARCH 17 (Student Entry / Breakfast: 07:15 AM)

- **Pd00:** 08:00 AM – 11:15 AM (3h 15m | Testing Period)
- **Pd01:** 11:18 AM – 11:33 AM (15m)
- **Pd02:** 11:36 PM – 11:51 PM (15m)
- **Pd03:** 11:54 PM – 12:09 PM (15m)
- **Pd04:** 12:12 PM – 12:27 PM (15m)
- **Pd05:** 12:30 PM – 01:10 PM (40m)
- **Pd06:** 01:13 PM – 01:53 PM (40m)
- **Pd07:** 01:56 PM – 02:11 PM (15m)
- **Pd08:** 02:14 PM – 02:29 PM (15m)
- **Pd09:** 02:32 PM – 03:18 PM (46m)

DAY 04: WEDNESDAY / MARCH 18 (Student Entry / Breakfast: 07:15 AM)

- **Pd00:** 08:00 AM – 9:45AM (1h 45m | Testing Period)
- **Pd01:** 9:48 AM – 10:10AM (22m)
- **Pd02:** 10:13AM – 10:35AM (22m)
- **Pd03:** 10:38AM – 11:00AM (22m)
- **Pd04:** 11:03AM – 11:25AM (22m)
- **Pd05:** 11:28AM – 11:50AM (22m)
- **Pd06:** 11:53AM – 12:15PM (22m)
- **Pd07:** 12:18PM – 12:58PM (40m)
- **Pd08:** 01:01PM – 01:41PM (40m)
- **Pd09:** 01:44PM – 02:24PM (40m)

The shortened scheduled for midterms(Arma Rahman)

Shanel Stewart, a junior at Edison noted while they were satisfied with how it was planned, they found that the school lacked proper scheduling and planning.

BELL SCHEDULE – SAT EXAM

Wednesday/April 22 (Student Entry/Breakfast: 7am)

- Pd00: 08:00 AM – 11:15 AM (3h 15m/Testing Period)
- Pd01 11:18 AM – 11:25 AM (7m)
- Pd02 11:28 AM – 11:35 AM (7m)
- Pd03 11:38 AM – 11:45 AM (7m)
- Pd04 11:48 AM – 12:08 PM (20m)
- Pd05 12:11 PM – 12:31 PM (20m)
- Pd06 12:34 PM – 12:54 PM (20m)
- Pd07 12:57 PM – 01:17 PM (20m)
- Pd08 01:20 PM – 01:41 PM (21m)
- Pd09 01:44 PM – 02:24 PM (40m)

BELL SCHEDULE – PSAT EXAM

Thursday/April 23 (Student Entry/Breakfast: 7am)

- Pd00: 08:00 AM – 11:15 AM (3h 15m/Testing Period)
- Pd01 11:18 AM – 11:28 AM (10m)
- Pd02 11:31 AM – 11:41 AM (10m)
- Pd03 11:44 AM – 12:09 PM (25m)
- Pd04 12:12 PM – 12:37 PM (25m)
- Pd05 12:40 PM – 01:05 PM (25m)
- Pd06 01:08 PM – 01:33 PM (25m)
- Pd07 01:36 PM – 02:01 PM (25m)
- Pd08 02:04 PM – 02:29 PM (25m)
- Pd09 02:32 PM – 03:18 PM (46m)

The SAT/PSAT schedule (Arma Rahman)

"I personally think that it's annoying that the SAT weren't their own day like they didn't close the school for that but personally, I just don't like when we have like really big tests like the SAT or when they made us do the practice regent for U.S. I didn't like that it was just like a regular school day afterwards. One because it was really confusing since we all had to start at 11 and it also didn't give teachers enough time to actually teach so in the majority of my classes I just sat there and did nothing. Nor did I like the shortened lunch as you would have to rush to get food and then rush to eat," said Stewart.

Sarvagya Banjwal, a sophomore at Edison, wished that the school had given a notice early.

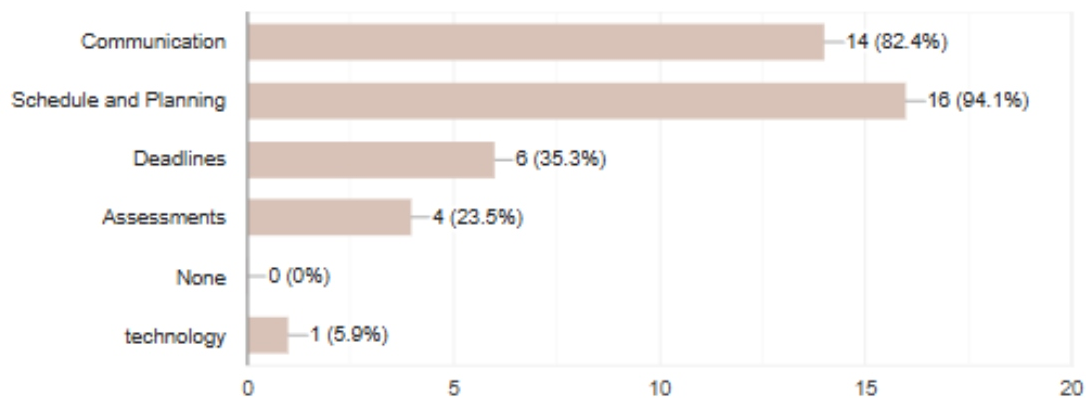
"Honestly most of the mid terms and the sat stuff was fine but there could have been a month's notice for these schedules. A day for testing only and no classes would be nice but mixing the schedule was a strange thing to adjust to. It took time from learning just to make up the hours. Otherwise if we were told months in advance (like knowing we have Regents) we would have more time to prepare," Banjwal said.

Sadiya Hosein, a junior at Edison, brings up how the last minute notice of schedules affected the students.

"A lot of scheduling is very last minute, barely giving students a heads up. For example, the SAT test date was released about a week or so before testing began, and before they released the actual date they kept changing up when they would host the exam, like saying it would take place in March and then switched it up to early May, which pressures a lot of students to study really hard knowing that there wasn't actually an exam," said Hosein.

Which category do you think was the school lacking?

17 responses



Survey summary that answers our question: Which category do you think was the school lacking? (Elizabeth Brooks)

To possibly avoid future conflicts and misunderstanding like this year, we asked Edison students what could be improved regarding future testing situations so that testing season is a smoother and simple experience for students.

Mirian Menchu, a junior at Edison, discusses that she would have liked it if the school had informed them about the important details surrounding the tests at an earlier date.

"I would like it if they told us the deadline, the schedule, and when it was going to be rather than tell us at the last minute," Menchu said.

Banjwal suggests that the school could improve on time and communication.

"I would suggest possibly working on time and communication. Mention at least a month before that we have this exam with a short schedule after," Banjwal said.